

Exercise 2: Lutts & Mipps

Goals:

To study the sharing of information within a team

To focus on cooperation in team problem solving

To offer the team members an opportunity to observe the emergence of leadership behavior in team problem solving

Group size:

5-13 cadets

Time:

1-1.5 hours

Material:

-- A copy of the Lutts and Mipps Instruction Sheet for the team

-- Lutts and Mipps Information Cards (26 cards)

-- A copy of the Lutts and Mipps Reaction Sheet for each team member

Process:

- Distribute a copy of the Lutts and Mipps Instruction Sheet to the team and tell them to read it (5 minutes)
- Distribute the Lutts and Mipps Information Cards to the members, evenly distributing them. All of the cards must be distributed.
- Tell the team to begin its work
- After 20 minutes, give each member a copy of the Lutts and Mipps Reaction Sheet and tell them to complete the sheet individually. Give the members 15 minutes to complete the sheet.
- Announce the solution (23/30 words) and then lead a discussion based on the Reaction Sheet. Encourage the team members to share information from their completed forms. Use the remaining time for the discussion.

Lutts and Mipps Instruction Sheet

- Pretend lutts and mipps represent a new way of measuring distance and that dars, wors, and mirs represent a new way of measuring time.
 - A man drives from Town A, through Town B and Town C, to Town D
- Your team's task is to determine how many wors the entire trip took.
 - You have 20 minutes to complete this task
 - Do not choose a formal leader

- You will be given cards containing information related to the task
 - You may share this information orally, but you must keep your cards in your hands throughout the activity

Lutts and Mipps Information
(Type on-line each on 26 3x5 cards)

How far is it from A to B?

It is 4 lutts from A to B.

How far is it from B to C?

It is 8 lutts from B to C.

How far is it from C to D?

It is 10 lutts from C to D.

What is a lutt?

A lutt is 10 mipps.

What is a mipp?

A mipp is a way of measuring distance.

How many mipps are there in a mile?

There are two mipps in a mile.

What is a dar?

A dar is 10 wors.

What is a wor?

A wor is five mirs.

What is a mir?

A mir is a way of measuring time.

How many mirs are there in an hour?

There are two mirs an hour.

How fast does the man drive from A to B?

The man drives from A to B at the rate of 24 lutts per wor.

How fast does the man drive from B to C?

The man drives from B to C at the rate of 30 lutts per wor.

How fast does the man drive from C to D?

The man drives from C to D at the rate of 30 lutts per wor.

Lutts and Mipps Reaction Sheet

1. How did the team approach the sharing of information? (What techniques were used?)
2. Whose participants were most helpful in the accomplishment of the task?
 - a) What particular behaviors were helpful?
3. Whose participants seemed to hinder the accomplishment of the task?
 - a) What particular behaviors seemed to be a hindrance?
4. What feelings did you experience while the team was working on the problem?
5. What role(s) did you play in the team?
6. Who assumed leadership roles during the problem-solving task?
 - a) How would you describe the leadership behaviors that emerged?
 - b) What were the effects of these behaviors on the completion of the task?
 - c) How would you characterize the team members' response to the leadership behaviors that emerged?
7. What have you learned about your personal approach to problem solving?
 - a) What have you learned about the team's approach?
 - b) How can you use what you have learned when the team works on real problems?